

None of these things should be too much to ask. When asked about financial wellbeing, almost nobody is aspiring to riches beyond their wildest dreams, or abundant material possessions – they just want to feel in control and at peace. Later in this book we will discuss the forces pushing us to aspire to material wealth rather than financial wellbeing, and how, if we don't have a solid idea ourselves of what a good relationship with money would look like, we risk never reaching a state of peace or contentment.

In recent months, I've seen 'financial wellbeing' co-opted by so many brands and publications as a way to repackage the same old advice that hasn't really been engaging or serving anyone for decades. This isn't that – or at least I really hope it isn't. Financial wellbeing is not a number or a percentage, as I've seen claimed in one Twitter thread, nor is it a certain budgeting technique or anything, really, that can be described in fewer than 280 characters. It is something deeply personal, constantly fluctuating and sometimes elusive. Something that requires at least, I don't know, 50,000 words or so to get to grips with. As glad as I am to see the concept firmly on the agenda, I'm keen to ensure that it's given its proper context and rightful place, because to lump it in with the 50-30-20 budgeting method is reductive and unhelpful. To suggest that there is one prescription that will treat any number of financial health issues is not helpful, because it's just not true. Your financial wellbeing is deeply personal and bespoke to you, and so it is up to you to figure out exactly